



Line graphs

LINE GRAPHS SHOW DATA AS LINES ON A SET OF AXES.

Line graphs are a way of accurately presenting information in an easy-to-read form. They are particularly useful for showing data over a period of time.

Drawing a line graph

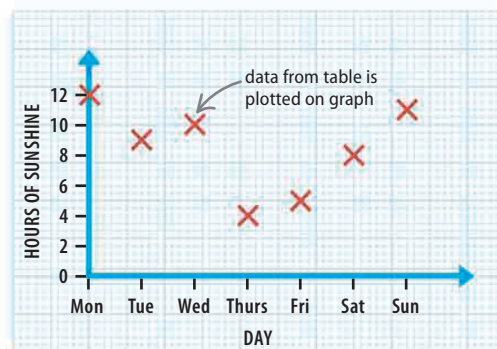
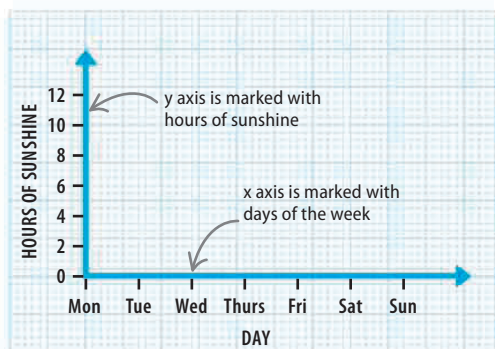
A pencil, a ruler, and graph paper are all that is needed to draw a line graph. Data from a table is plotted on the graph, and these points are joined to create a line.

SEE ALSO

◀ 182–185 Linear graphs

◀ 204–205 Collecting and organizing data

Day	Sunshine (hours)
Monday	12
Tuesday	9
Wednesday	10
Thursday	4
Friday	5
Saturday	8
Sunday	11



The columns of the table provide the information for the horizontal and vertical lines—the x and y axes.

Draw a set of axes. Label the x axis with data from the first column of the table (days). Label the y axis with data from the second (hours of sunshine).

Read up the y axis from Monday on the x axis and mark the first value. Do this for each day, reading up from the x axis and across from the y axis.

Use a ruler and a pen or pencil to connect the points and complete the line graph once all the data has been marked (or plotted). The resulting line clearly shows the relationship between the two sets of data.

